

Algebraic Geometry

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1 Sheaves

1.1 Definitions

1.1.1 Definition

For a topological space X , its set of open subsets $\text{open}(X)$ is partially ordered by inclusion, and thus forms a small category. It is also a cofiltered category: for every $U, V \in \text{open}(X)$ they have a lower bound $U \cap V$.

1.1.2 Definition

Let X be a topological space, and $\mathcal{C}$ a category. A **$\mathcal{C}$ -valued presheaf on X** is a contravariant functor $\mathcal{F}: \text{open}(X)^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$. It is customary to denote $\mathcal{F}(U \subseteq V): \mathcal{F}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)$ by res_U^V . When $\mathcal{C}$ is a concrete category (i.e. its objects are sets), elements of $\mathcal{F}(U)$ are called **sections of $\mathcal{F}$ over U** , and for a section $s \in \mathcal{F}(V)$ we write $s|_U$ for $\text{res}_U^V(s)$.

A **morphism of presheaves** is a natural transformation.

Denote the category of $\mathcal{C}$ -valued presheaves on X by $\text{Psh}_{\mathcal{C}}(X)$.

1.1.3 Example

Let E be a set (or a topological space, or any mathematical object which lies in the same category as X and its open subsets). We can then define the presheaf of functions on E by $\mathcal{F}(U) = \text{hom}(U, E)$: the set of all functions $U \rightarrow E$. The restriction maps are very literally restriction: for $U \subseteq V$ and $f: V \rightarrow E$, we restrict f to U to obtain a function $f|_U: U \rightarrow E$.

1.1.4 Definition

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf over X valued in a category $\mathcal{C}$ with filtered colimits, and $p \in X$. Then $\mathcal{U}(p) = \{U \subseteq \text{open} \mid p \in U\}$, the set of neighborhoods of p , is a cofiltered subcategory of $\text{open}(X)$, and so $\mathcal{F}$ restricts to a functor from $\mathcal{U}(p)^{\text{op}}$. Define $\mathcal{F}$'s **stalk** at p to be the filtered colimit

$$\mathcal{F}_p = \text{colim}_{U \in \mathcal{U}(p)} \mathcal{F}(U) \in \mathcal{C}.$$

For concrete categories, this is the set of **germs** of $\mathcal{F}$ at p :

$$\mathcal{F}_p = \{(U, s) \mid U \in \mathcal{U}(p), s \in \mathcal{F}(U)\},$$

modulo the relation where we identify (s, U) and (t, V) if there is a subset $p \in W \subseteq U, V$ such that $s|_W = t|_W$.

Taking colimits is functorial, so the correspondence $p \mapsto \mathcal{F}_p$ is functorial. Explicitly $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a morphism of sheaves over X valued in a concrete category, and $p \in X$ we define $\varphi_p: \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p$ by

$$\varphi_p(U, s) = (U, \varphi_U(s)).$$

1.1.5 Definition

A presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on X (valued in a concrete category) is a **sheaf** if it satisfies the **sheaf axiom**: for every

open subset $U \subseteq X$ and open cover $\{U_i\}$ of U and sections $s_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$, if $s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ for all i, j then there exists a *unique* $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $s|_{U_i} = s_i$ for all i .

We can split the sheaf axiom in two:

- (1) the **identity axiom**: if $\{U_i\}$ is an open cover of U , and $s_1, s_2 \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ are such that $s_1|_{U_i} = s_2|_{U_i}$ for all i , then $s_1 = s_2$.
- (2) the **gluability axiom**: the sheaf axiom without requiring uniqueness.

We can also state the sheaf axiom categorically. For every open cover $\{U_i\}$ of U , we can consider the following diagram:

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{\text{res}} \prod_i \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightleftharpoons[\text{res}_j]{\text{res}_i} \prod_{i,j} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j),$$

where $\mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{\text{res}} \prod_i \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ is the map $s \mapsto (s|_{U_i})_i$, res_1 and res_2 are the maps

$$\text{res}_1(s_i)_i = (s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j}, \quad \text{res}_2(s_i)_i = (s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j}.$$

Categorically, res_1 's coordinate to $\mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$ composes the i th projection with $\text{res}_{U_i \cap U_j}^{U_i}$, and res_2 's coordinate composes the j th projection with $\text{res}_{U_i \cap U_j}^{U_j}$. These maps are defined for any presheaf, and we can see that $\mathcal{F}$ is a presheaf iff this is an equalizer diagram.

Indeed, the equalizer of $\text{res}_1, \text{res}_2$ are all $(s_i)_i$ such that $s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$, i.e. a family of sections which agree on the overlaps. And there is an $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ whose projections $s|_{U_i}$ are s_i when the gluing axiom is satisfied, and it is unique (so an embedding, and thus an equalizer) when the identity lemma is satisfied.

This allows us to generalize sheaves to any category $\mathcal{C}$ with arbitrary products.

The category of $\mathcal{C}$ -valued sheaves on X is denoted $\text{Sh}_{\mathcal{C}}(X)$, it is a full subcategory of $\text{Psh}_{\mathcal{C}}(X)$; meaning sheaf morphisms are just presheaf morphisms between sheaves. The stalk of a sheaf at a point is just the stalk of it as a presheaf.

1.1.6 Example

If $\mathcal{F}$ is a presheaf on X , and $U \subseteq X$ is open, we define $\mathcal{F}$'s **restriction** to U to be the presheaf $\mathcal{F}|_U$ on U defined for $V \subseteq U$ by $\mathcal{F}|_U(V) = \mathcal{F}(V)$ (it is just the restriction of the functor $\mathcal{F}$ to the subcategory $\text{open}(U)$). If $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf, its restriction is clearly a sheaf as well.

1.1.7 Example

Let X be a topological space, $p \in X$, and S a set (or a group, module, etc.). We define the **skyscraper sheaf** p_*S by

$$p_*S(U) = \begin{cases} S & \text{if } p \in U \\ * & \text{else} \end{cases},$$

where $*$ is a single-point set; the restrictions are given by the identities or the unique morphism $S \rightarrow *$. This is indeed a sheaf: if $p \in U$ and $\{U_i\}$ is a covering of U with $s_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that $s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ then for every $p \in U_i$ we have a single value $s \in S$ which is equal to all $s_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$, this is the glued section. Otherwise $p \notin U$ and s_i are all the unique element in $*$, so s must be too.

1.1.8 Example

Let X be a topological space and S a set. The **constant presheaf** associated with S is the presheaf $\underline{S}_{\text{pre}}$ which maps all open sets U to S . This is a presheaf, but not a sheaf in general. For example if $X = \{p, q\}$

is the two point space with the discrete topology then take $s_p \neq s_q$; they cannot be glued to a global section on X .

If we instead define $\underline{S}(U)$ to be the set of locally constant functions $U \rightarrow S$, then this is a sheaf, called the **constant sheaf**. It is just the sheaf of continuous functions $\underline{S}(U) = C(U, S)$ with S given the discrete topology. The sheaf of continuous functions $C(\bullet, Y)$ is a sheaf in general (by the gluing lemma from topology).

1.1.9 Example

Let $\pi: X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map, and $\mathcal{F}$ a presheaf over X . Define the **pushforward** (or **direct image**) presheaf $\pi_*\mathcal{F}$ by

$$\pi_*\mathcal{F}(V) = \mathcal{F}(\pi^{-1}V),$$

for $V \subseteq Y$, and $\text{res}_W^V = \text{res}_{\pi^{-1}W}^{\pi^{-1}V}$. This is clearly a presheaf; if $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf it is also a sheaf. Indeed, if $V \subseteq Y$ is open and $\{V_i\}_i$ is a cover with $s_i \in \pi_*\mathcal{F}(V_i) = \mathcal{F}(\pi^{-1}V_i)$. Then the glue of these is unique, because $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf.

The skyscraper sheaf p_*S is the pushforward of the constant sheaf $\underline{S}$ by the inclusion $\{p\} \rightarrow X$.

An important property of the direct image sheaf is that it is functorial: if $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a morphism of presheaves over X , then $\pi_*\varphi: \pi_*\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \pi_*\mathcal{G}$ defined by $\pi_*\varphi_V = \varphi_{\pi^{-1}V}$ is a morphism of presheaves.

Note that if $\pi: X \rightarrow Y$ is continuous, $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf over X , and $\pi(p) = q$, then there is a natural morphism of stalks

$$(\pi_*\mathcal{F})_q \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p.$$

Indeed, the left-hand side is

$$\text{colim}_{q \in V} \mathcal{F}(\pi^{-1}V) = \text{colim}_{p \in \pi^{-1}V} \mathcal{F}(\pi^{-1}V).$$

Now a cone under $\mathcal{F}$ defines a unique cone under $\pi_*\mathcal{F}$ simply by restricting, and since $\text{colim } \pi_*\mathcal{F}$ is the initial cone under $\pi_*\mathcal{F}$ there is a canonical map to this restricted cone, in particular for $\text{colim } \mathcal{F}$.

In more concrete terms, $(\pi_*\mathcal{F})_q$ has elements (s, V) for $s \in \mathcal{F}(\pi^{-1}V)$, which we then map to $(s, \pi^{-1}V) \in \mathcal{F}_p$.

1.1.10 Definition

If $\mathcal{O}_X$ is a sheaf of rings over a topological space X (i.e. a sheaf over X valued in the category of rings), then the pair $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is called a **ringed space**; $\mathcal{O}_X$ is called the **structure sheaf**. Sections of $\mathcal{O}_X$ over $U \subseteq X$ are called **functions** on U , global sections are called **global functions**.

1.1.11 Definition

If $\mathcal{O}_X$ is a ringed space, an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -**module** is a sheaf of Abelian groups $\mathcal{F}$ over X such that for each $U \subseteq X$, $\mathcal{F}(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -module, and all of these modules are well-behaved in that when $U \subseteq V$, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(V) \times \mathcal{F}(V) & \xrightarrow{\text{mult}} & \mathcal{F}(V) \\ \text{res}_{V,U} \times \text{res}_{V,U} \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{res}_{V,U} \\ \mathcal{O}_X(U) \times \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\text{mult}} & \mathcal{F}(U) \end{array}$$

The horizontal arrows are $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$'s action on $\mathcal{F}(U)$.

The commutative diagram means that

$$(s \cdot x)|_U = (s|_U) \cdot (x|_U),$$

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for $s \in \mathcal{O}_X(V), x \in \mathcal{F}(V)$.

Note that just as modules generalize the concept of an Abelian group (Abelian groups are $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules), $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules generalize the concept of a sheaf of Abelian groups. Indeed, a sheaf of Abelian groups is just an $\mathbb{Z}$ -module. Every $\mathbb{Z}$ -module is a sheaf of Abelian groups by definition, and conversely a sheaf of Abelian groups has a unique $\mathbb{Z}$ -module structure where for $U \subseteq X$ connected we have $\mathbb{Z}(U) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ which has a unique multiplication on $\mathcal{F}(U) \in \mathbf{Ab}$. We extend this to arbitrary $U \subseteq X$ by gluing.

1.1.12 Proposition

If $\mathcal{F}$ is an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, then for each $p \in X$, $\mathcal{F}_p$ is an $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ -module.

Proof

The condition that $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module means that multiplication is a natural map $\mathcal{O}_X \times \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$. Colimits are taken pointwise in functor categories (in particular for the product of functors), so this gives a natural map $\mathcal{O}_{X,p} \times \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p$. The natural map is given by mapping $(s, U), (x, V)$ to $(sx, U \cap V)$, which is easily seen to give a module structure. $\blacksquare$

1.1.13 Example

Consider a smooth manifold X ; this defines a ringed space $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ where $\mathcal{O}_X$ is the sheaf of smooth real-valued functions: $\mathcal{O}_X(U) = C^\infty(U)$. These are all real algebras, so we could view this as an $\mathbb{R}$ -ringed space.

If $\pi: V \rightarrow X$ is a vector bundle over X , then consider the sheaf of smooth local sections of π :

$$\Gamma(U) = \{\sigma: U \rightarrow V \text{ smooth} \mid \pi \circ \sigma = \text{id}_U\}.$$

Then Γ is an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module: it is a classical result that a local section defined on U can be multiplied by a smooth real-valued function defined on U .

1.2 The category of sheaves

As discussed, presheaves form a category for which sheaves form a full subcategory. We will denote the category of $\mathcal{C}$ -valued presheaves over a space X by $\mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$ (instead of $\mathbf{Psh}_{\mathcal{C}}(X)$), and we will denote the full subcategory of sheaves by $\mathcal{C}_X \subseteq \mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$.

Note that if $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G} \in \mathcal{C}_X$ are sheaves (or presheaves), then the hom-set of sheaf morphisms $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is indeed a set, since X as a category is small (functor categories under small categories are locally small). Furthermore, if $\mathcal{C}$ is enriched over some monoidal category (in our case, usually $\mathbf{Ab}$) so is $\mathcal{C}_X$. This is because it is true in general for functor categories over enriched categories.

1.2.1 Definition

Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -valued sheaves defined on X . Define their **sheaf-hom** to be the sheaf whose sections are sheaf morphisms,

$$\mathbf{Hom}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})(U) = \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}_X}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U).$$

As discussed, if $\mathcal{C}$ is enriched over a monoidal category $\mathcal{V}$ then so is $\mathcal{C}_X$, and so $\mathbf{Hom}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$ takes values in $\mathcal{V}$. In particular, if $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ are sheaves of Abelian groups, then so is their sheaf-hom.

1.2.2 Proposition

The sheaf-hom is indeed a sheaf.

Proof

We first show it is a sheaf: if $U \subseteq V$ then a sheaf morphism $\mathcal{F}|_V \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_V$ restricts to a sheaf morphism $\mathcal{F}|_U \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_U$ in the obvious way: its components are the same but only taken on subsets of U . This is clearly a presheaf.

To show that it is a sheaf, let $\{U_i\}$ be an open cover for $U \subseteq X$, and $\alpha_i: \mathcal{F}|_{U_i} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_{U_i}$ be sheaf morphisms such that $\alpha_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \alpha_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ for all i, j . In order to glue them together for a sheaf morphism $\alpha: \mathcal{F}_U \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_U$ we need to define α_W for all $W \subseteq U$. For $s \in \mathcal{F}(W)$ consider $s_i = s|_{U_i} \in \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap W)$, and its image under α_i to $\mathcal{G}(U_i \cap W)$, call it t_i . Then since $U_i \cap W$ cover W and since α is a morphism as well as $\mathcal{G}$ being a sheaf, we can uniquely glue t_i together to get a $t \in \mathcal{G}(W)$; this will be the image of s .

It is not hard to see that this is the unique gluing of α_i , and is itself a sheaf morphism. $\blacksquare$

Note:

In the above proof we needed only for $\mathcal{G}$ to be a sheaf, $\mathcal{F}$ can be a presheaf.

Furthermore **Hom** forms a bifunctor

$$\mathbf{Hom}: \mathcal{C}_X^{\text{op}} \times \mathcal{C}_X \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}_X,$$

or V_X instead of $\mathbf{Set}_X$ when $\mathcal{C}$ is enriched over V .

Note that if $\mathcal{O}_X$ is a ringed space, it is also a module over itself. Thus if $\mathcal{F}$ is an $\mathcal{O}_X$ module, we can form its **dual**:

$$\mathcal{F}^\vee = \mathbf{Hom}_{\text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{O}_X).$$

We now focus on sheaves of Abelian groups. It is a classical result that functor categories over Abelian categories are Abelian, thus $\mathbf{Ab}_X^{\text{pre}}$ is an Abelian category. That is to say, the hom-sets (not hom-sheaves) have an Abelian group structure: for $\varphi, \psi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ we can define $\varphi + \psi$ and $-\varphi$ by $(\varphi + \psi)(U) = \varphi(U) + \psi(U)$ and $(-\varphi)(U) = -\varphi(U)$. And we can form kernels and cokernels so that all monomorphisms are kernels and all epimorphisms are cokernels.

As with all limits in functor categories, these are done coordinate-wise. That is to say, if we denote by $\ker_{\text{pre}}$ and $\text{coker}_{\text{pre}}$ the kernel and cokernel of Abelian presheaf morphisms, we have

$$(\ker_{\text{pre}} \varphi)(U) = \ker(\varphi(U)), \quad (\text{coker}_{\text{pre}} \varphi)(U) = \text{coker}(\varphi(U)).$$

1.2.3 Remark

Let I be an indexing category and $\mathcal{C}$ be a category with arbitrary pullbacks. It is easy to see that a $\mathcal{C}$ -morphism $f: X \rightarrow Y$ is monic iff the following square is a pullback:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{\quad \text{id} \quad} & X \\ \text{id} \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ X & \xrightarrow{\quad f \quad} & Y \end{array}$$

Because the functor category $[I, \mathcal{C}]$ also has arbitrary pullbacks, a natural transformation $\alpha: \mathcal{F} \Rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is monic iff a similar diagram is a pullback. Because limits in a functor category are taken coordinate-wise, this is iff $\alpha(i)$ is monic for all $i \in I$.

Thus a natural transformation is monic iff its coordinates are.

Similarly, if $\mathcal{C}$ has arbitrary pushouts, natural transformations in $[I, \mathcal{C}]$ are epic iff their coordinates are.

In lieu of this note, we see that $\mathbf{Ab}_X^{\text{pre}}$ forms an Abelian category. Indeed, if $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \Rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a monic morphism of presheaves, then $\varphi(U): \mathcal{F}(U) \Rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$ is a monic morphism of Abelian groups for all $U \subseteq X$. Thus $\varphi(U) = \ker \text{coker } \varphi(U)$ for all $U \subseteq X$ and thus $\varphi = \ker \text{coker } \varphi$ as desired. Similar for epic morphisms.

6 Sheafification

Many properties of $\mathbf{Ab}_X^{\text{pre}}$ are seen to be pointwise. For one, if we set an open set $U \subseteq X$, the functor $\mathbf{Ab}_X^{\text{pre}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ mapping $\mathcal{F} \mapsto \mathcal{F}(U)$ is an exact functor. Indeed, it is additive and preserves kernels and cokernels because these are taken pointwise.

Furthermore, a sequence of presheaves

$$\mathcal{F}_1 \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_2 \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_n$$

is exact iff $\mathcal{F}_1(U) \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_n(U)$ is for all $U \subseteq X$. Again, this is an immediate consequence of kernels and cokernels (and thus images) being taken coordinate-wise.

Everything we have said holds for presheaves valued in any Abelian category $\mathcal{A}$ (recall that Abelian categories have all finite limits and colimits). But we are more interested in the category of sheaves, in which case this is less obvious.

Note that the constant presheaf 0_{pre} is a sheaf, so we can denote it by 0 without confusion. In order to show that $\mathcal{A}_X$ is an Abelian category, we must first show that kernels and cokernels exist in it. The following proposition shows that the kernel of a sheaf morphism is the same as the kernel of a presheaf morphism, and thus we get the existence of kernels for free.

1.2.4 Proposition

If $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a morphism of sheaves, then $\ker_{\text{pre}} \varphi$ is a sheaf. Thus $\ker \varphi = \ker_{\text{pre}} \varphi$ forms a kernel in the category of sheaves.

Proof

We show this for $\mathcal{A} = \mathbf{Ab}$: if $\{U_i\}_i$ is an open cover of $U \subseteq X$ and $s_i \in \ker \varphi(U_i)$ are such that $s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ for all i, j , then by gluing they form a section $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$. And by naturality

$$\varphi(U)(s)|_{U_i} = \varphi(U_i)(s|_{U_i}) = \varphi(U_i)(s_i) = 0.$$

The unique gluing of $0 \in \mathcal{G}(U_i)$ is $0 \in \mathcal{G}(U)$, so that $\varphi(U)(s) = 0$, meaning $s \in \ker \varphi(U)$ as desired. $\blacksquare$

1.2.5 Remark

A generalization of the above proposition shows that limits taken in the category of presheaves of sheaves forms a sheaf. That is, if $\Phi: I \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_X$ is a functor, then consider the inclusion $\iota: \mathcal{C}_X \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$. Then $\lim \iota \circ \Phi$ is a sheaf, so $\lim \Phi$ exists in $\mathcal{C}_X$.

Thus if $\mathcal{C}$ has arbitrary pullbacks, so too does $\mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$ and thus so too does $\mathcal{C}_X$. It then follows that a morphism of sheaves is monic iff its monic as a morphism of presheaves (considering the pullback condition remark 1.2.3) iff each component is monic (again by remark 1.2.3).

Unfortunately we now run in to our first hurdle: presheaf cokernels are not sheaves.

1.2.6 Example

Consider $\mathbb{C}$ with its usual topology, and let $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be the sheaf of holomorphic functions. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the presheaf of functions admitting a holomorphic logarithm. Consider the following exact sequence of presheaves

$$0 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}} \xrightarrow{\exp(2\pi i)} \mathcal{F} \rightarrow 0,$$

where the second map is $f \mapsto \exp(2\pi i f)$. This is indeed an exact sequence of presheaves: the first morphism is an embedding, and the second is epic (if $f = \exp(g)$ then $g/2\pi i \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}$ is an origin for f). The composition is zero, as $\exp(2\pi i n) = 0$, and if $\exp(2\pi i f) = 0$ then $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}$ for all $x \in \mathbb{C}$. Because $\mathbb{Z}$ is discrete, this means $f \in \mathbb{Z}$ as desired.

This shows that $\mathcal{F}$ is the cokernel of $\mathbb{Z} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}$: but it is not a sheaf! Indeed $\text{id}: \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ has a local logarithm at every point in its domain, but no global logarithm. Thus $\mathcal{F}$ fails the gluing axiom.

Thus for now we must wait to demonstrate that $\mathcal{A}_X$ is an Abelian category.

1.3 Sheafification

There is a natural map

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p,$$

for every $p \in U$ given by mapping $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ to $(U, s) \in \mathcal{F}_p$. Together these assimilate into a map

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p.$$

1.3.1 Proposition

The natural map above is injective when $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf.

Proof

Suppose that $s, t \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $(U, s) = (U, t)$ in $\mathcal{F}_p$. Then there exists a neighborhood $p \in W_p \subseteq U$ such that $s|_{W_p} = t|_{W_p}$. If this is true for all p , then W_p form an open cover of U and by the identity axiom, $s = t$. ■

1.3.2 Definition

An element $(s_p)_p \in \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$ consists of **compatible germs** if for all $p \in U$, s_p has a representative $\tilde{s}_p \in \mathcal{F}(U_p)$ for $p \in U_p \subseteq U$ such that the germ of $\tilde{s}_p$ at $q \in U_p$ is s_q for all $q \in U_p$.

Equivalently, this says that there is an open cover $\{U_i\}$ of U and sections $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that if $p \in U_i$ then s_p is the germ of f_i at p . If s is a section of $\mathcal{F}$ over U , then $(s)_p$ consists of compatible germs.

1.3.3 Proposition

The natural map $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$'s image is precisely the compatible germs.

Proof

We already showed that every tuple in its image consists of compatible germs, now we show the converse. Suppose $(s_p)_p$ consists of compatible germs, so let $\tilde{s}_p \in \mathcal{F}(U_p)$ be a representation as in the definition. Then U_p cover U , and $\tilde{s}_p|_{U_p \cap U_q}$'s germ at q is s_q so that $\tilde{s}_p, \tilde{s}_q$ agree on a neighborhood of q and by symmetry in a neighborhood of p and q . ■

1.3.4 Proposition

Suppose $\mathcal{F}$ is a presheaf of sets and $\mathcal{G}$ a sheaf of sets, and $\varphi_1, \varphi_2: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ are two morphisms. Further suppose that φ_1, φ_2 induce the same map on each stalk; show that $\varphi_1 = \varphi_2$.

Proof

Consider the following diagram for $U \subseteq X$ open,

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\varphi_i} & \mathcal{G}(U) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \iota \\
\prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p & \xrightarrow{\prod \varphi_{i,p}} & \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{G}_p
\end{array}$$

for $i = 1, 2$. It is easily seen that this diagram commutes, and because $\varphi_{1,p} = \varphi_{2,p}$ for all $p \in U$ it follows that

$$\iota \circ \varphi_1 = \iota \circ \varphi_2$$

and since ι is injective by proposition 1.3.1, we get that $\varphi_1 = \varphi_2$ as desired. $\blacksquare$

1.3.5 Proposition

A morphism of sheaves of sets is injective iff it induces an injection on all stalks. Similarly it is an isomorphism iff it induces an isomorphism on all stalks.

Proof

If $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is an isomorphism, then by functoriality $\varphi_p: \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p$ is as well for all p . Similarly if it is an injection then $\varphi_p(s_p) = \varphi_p(t_p)$ then $\varphi(s)$ and $\varphi(t)$ are equal in a subset $V \subseteq U$ so that $\varphi(s|_V) = \varphi(t|_V)$ and by injectivity this means that $s|_V = t|_V$ and thus $s_p = t_p$.

Conversely consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & \mathcal{G}(U) \\
\downarrow \iota_{\mathcal{F}} & & \downarrow \iota_{\mathcal{G}} \\
\prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{G}_p
\end{array}$$

where the bottom horizontal arrow is the injection/isomorphism $\prod_{p \in U} \varphi_p$. Then $\iota_{\mathcal{G}} \circ \varphi$ is injective, and so φ is.

Now to show that φ is surjective, let $s \in \mathcal{G}(U)$. Then $\iota_{\mathcal{G}}(s) \in \prod_U \mathcal{G}_p$ consists of compatible germs, and mapping it back to $\prod_U \mathcal{F}_p$ we see that it still consists of compatible germs. Thus it lies in the image of $\iota_{\mathcal{F}}$ by proposition 1.3.3, and thus has a preimage in $\mathcal{F}(U)$. Because all of the maps are injective, this is the preimage of s in $\mathcal{F}(U)$ as desired. $\blacksquare$

Note:

It is not true that sheaves with isomorphic stalks are isomorphic: there may not be an isomorphism between the sheaves which induces these isomorphisms.

1.3.6 Theorem (Sheafification)

The inclusion $\text{Set}_X \hookrightarrow \text{Set}_X^{\text{pre}}$ has a left adjoint, called **sheafification**: $\text{sh}: \text{Set}_X^{\text{pre}} \rightarrow \text{Set}_X$.

Proof

We need to show for any presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ there exists a sheaf $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ and morphism $\text{sh}: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ such that for every sheaf $\mathcal{G}$ and morphism $g: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ there exists a unique morphism $f: \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ such that the below diagram

commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F} & \xrightarrow{\text{sh}} & \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \\ & \searrow g & \downarrow \exists! f \\ & & \mathcal{G} \end{array}$$

We construct $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ explicitly. For $U \subseteq X$ open, define

$$\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) = \left\{ (f_p)_{p \in U} \mid \begin{array}{l} \text{for all } p \in U \text{ there exists a neighborhood } p \in V \subseteq U \text{ and } s \in \mathcal{F}(V) \\ \text{such that } s_q = f_q \text{ for all } q \in V \end{array} \right\},$$

where by s_q we mean the germ of s in $\mathcal{F}_q$. For $U \subseteq V$ there is an obvious map $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ mapping $(f_p)_{p \in V} \mapsto (f_p)_{p \in U}$; it is easily seen that $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is a presheaf.

Note that the construction of $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ is just the set of all families of compatible germs over U , which we discussed in the previous few results.

Now let $U \subseteq X$ be open and $\{U_i\}_i$ an open cover of U . Then if we have $(f_p^i)_{p \in U_i} \in \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U_i)$ for all i which are compatible, this means $f_p^i = f_p^j$ for all $p \in U_i \cap U_j$. Then we must define $(f_p)_{p \in U}$ by $f_p = f_p^i$ for any $i \in U_i$ for which p is a member of. This is well-defined precisely by compatibility, and it is a member of $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ because for $p \in U$ there is a $p \in U_i \subseteq U$ and then there is a $p \in V \subseteq U_i$ and $s \in \mathcal{F}(V)$ such that $s_q = f_q^i = f_q$ for all $q \in V$ as desired. Thus $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is a sheaf.

Now we must demonstrate that $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ satisfies the universal property of a left adjoint. There is an obvious map $\text{sh}: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ which maps $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ to $(s_p)_{p \in U} \in \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ (this is a section because s satisfies the condition for it to be in $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$). Let $g: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism, and for $U \subseteq X$ consider the following diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\text{sh}} & \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) & \xrightarrow{\iota_{\mathcal{F}}} & \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p \\ & \searrow g & & & \downarrow \prod_p g_p \\ & & \mathcal{G}(U) & \xrightarrow{\iota_{\mathcal{G}}} & \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{G}_p \end{array}$$

Note that the image of $\prod_p g_p \circ \iota_{\mathcal{F}}$ consists of compatible germs in $\prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{G}_p$ and so we can fill this diagram in with a unique arrow $f: \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$. It is easy to see by uniqueness that these f assemble into a morphism $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$. ■

Note:

In the language of category theory, this theorem says that $\mathbf{Set}_X \subseteq \mathbf{Set}_X^{\text{pre}}$ is a **reflective subcategory**. Note that this proof works for other concrete categories like $\mathbf{Ab}$, $\mathbf{Grp}$, $\mathbf{Ring}$, etc. It can be shown that for sufficiently nice $\mathcal{C}$ (e.g. complete and cocomplete), sheafification exists for $\mathcal{C}_X \subseteq \mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$.

This justifies the fact that inclusion $\mathcal{C}_X \subseteq \mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$ preserves limits: it is a right adjoint. This explains why the presheaf kernel of a sheaf morphism is a sheaf kernel for example.

1.3.7 Proposition

The canonical morphism $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ induces an isomorphism on stalks.

Proof

This is easily seen by an explicit description of $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$'s stalks. ■

1.3.8 Remark (The space of sections of a presheaf)

Suppose $\mathcal{F}$ is a presheaf of sets on X . We will construct a topological space F along with a continuous map $\pi: F \rightarrow X$ as follows. As a set define F to be the disjoint unions of $\mathcal{F}$'s stalks:

$$F = \coprod_{p \in X} \mathcal{F}_p.$$

Now for $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ let $F_s = \{(p, s_p) \mid p \in U\} \subseteq F$; then the collection of all F_s where $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ for arbitrary $U \subseteq X$ forms a base for a topology on F . Indeed, for $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ and $t \in \mathcal{F}(V)$ we see that $F_s \cap F_t$ is the union of all F_r where $r = s|_W = t|_W$ for all $W \subseteq U \cap V$ where $s|_W = t|_W$.

The map $\pi: F \rightarrow X$ is the obvious projection $(p, s_p) \mapsto p$. For $U \subseteq X$ open we have that $\pi^{-1}U$ is the union of all F_s where $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ so that π is continuous. Furthermore π is an open map: for $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ it maps F_s to U . Moreover $\pi|_{F_s}$ is a bijection, so that π is a local homeomorphism.

The space F is called the **space of sections**, or **étalé space** of $\mathcal{F}$.

We can give an alternative construction for the sheafification of $\mathcal{F}$ as the sheaf of sections of $\pi: F \rightarrow X$ (that is for $U \subseteq X$ we define $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ to be the set of continuous maps $\sigma: U \rightarrow F$ where $\pi \circ \sigma = \text{id}_U$). Let us denote by $\mathcal{F}^+$ this new construction.

For $U \subseteq X$ open we define $\varphi: \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^+(U)$ by mapping $(f_p)_{p \in U}$ to $\sigma: U \rightarrow F, p \mapsto f_p$. Its inverse is given by mapping σ to $(\sigma(p))_p$.

1.3.9 Example

Let S be a set and consider the constant presheaf $\underline{S}_{\text{pre}}$. Then its sheafification is the constant *sheaf*: $(\underline{S}_{\text{pre}})^{\text{sh}} = \underline{S}$.

We can show this with the universal property: $\text{sh}: \underline{S}_{\text{pre}} \rightarrow \underline{S}$ is given by inclusion (constant maps are locally constant). Then for a morphism $g: \underline{S}_{\text{pre}} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ where $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf, we define $\bar{g}: \underline{S} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ by mapping a locally constant $f: U \rightarrow S$ to the gluing of $(\bar{g}(f|_{U_i}))_i$ (where $U_i \subseteq U$ are its connected components so that $f|_{U_i}$ is a constant).

Let $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of sheaves, then recall the following equivalences (see remark 1.2.5 and proposition 1.3.5):

- (1) φ is monic as a morphism of sheaves,
- (2) φ is monic as a morphism of presheaves,
- (3) $\varphi(U)$ is monic for all $U \subseteq X$,
- (4) φ_p is monic for all $p \in X$.

A similar equivalence does not hold true for epimorphisms. This boils down to the fact that inclusion $\mathcal{C}_X \subseteq \mathcal{C}_X^{\text{pre}}$ does not necessarily preserve colimits, and thus not epimorphisms. So while a presheaf morphism is epic iff its components are, the same does not hold for sheaf morphisms. But it is true that epimorphisms are determined by stalks.

1.3.10 Proposition

Let $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of sheaves. Then it is an epimorphism (in the category of sheaves) iff $\varphi_p: \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p$ is an epimorphism for all $p \in X$.

Proof

If φ_p is epic for all p , then suppose we have two sheaf morphisms $\psi_1, \psi_2: \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ such that $\psi_1 \circ \varphi = \psi_2 \circ \varphi$. Then taking stalks we see that for all p , $(\psi_1)_p \circ \varphi_p = (\psi_2)_p \circ \varphi_p$. Since φ_p is epic this means $(\psi_1)_p = (\psi_2)_p$ for all p and by proposition 1.3.4 this means $\psi_1 = \psi_2$ so that φ is epic.

Conversely let $p \in X$ and suppose there are maps $f, g: \mathcal{G}_p \rightarrow X$ such that $f \circ \varphi_p = g \circ \varphi_p$. We can define maps $\bar{f}, \bar{g}: \mathcal{G} \rightarrow p_*X$ by $\bar{f}_U(s) = f(s_p)$ for $p \in U$ and $\bar{f}_U = *$ otherwise. It is easy to see that $\bar{f} \circ \varphi = \bar{g} \circ \varphi$ and so $\bar{f} = \bar{g}$ which can easily be shown to mean $f = g$. ■

Note:

We will show that there is an adjunction between taking stalks and the skyscraper sheaf: $\bullet_p \dashv p_*\bullet$. This was used in the above proof, and it is easy to see then how to construct this.

1.3.11 Example

We will show that an epimorphism of sheaves need not be epic on each of its components.

Let $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be the sheaf of holomorphic functions and $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}^*$ be the sheaf of invertible (nowhere zero) holomorphic functions. These are sheaves of Abelian groups, and we then have maps of sheaves

$$0 \rightarrow \underline{\mathbb{Z}} \xrightarrow{\times 2\pi i} \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}} \xrightarrow{\exp} \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}^* \rightarrow 1.$$

We will soon show that this is an exact sequence of sheaves of Abelian groups.

In particular $\exp: \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}^*$ is an epimorphism as we can show directly. For any $z \in \mathbb{C}$ the morphism of stalks $\exp_z$ is surjective because every invertible holomorphic function locally has a logarithm. But $\exp$ is not an epimorphism on each of its components, for example $\text{id} \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{C}}^*(\mathbb{C} - 0)$ has no global logarithm.

1.4 B-Sheaves

Oftentimes it is more natural to define a sheaf on X by defining its sections on a base of X , instead of on every open subset of X . Recall that a base of a topology is a collection of open subsets $\mathcal{B} \subseteq \text{open}(X)$ such that every open subset of X can be written as a union of sets from $\mathcal{B}$.

In the absence of an ambient topology, we may mean a base to mean a collection $\mathcal{B}$ of subsets of X such that the intersection of any two sets from $\mathcal{B}$ can be written as a union of elements from $\mathcal{B}$. If we are given an arbitrary collection S of subsets of X , they generate a minimal topology on X ; S is called a **subbase** of this topology. The topology generated by $\mathcal{B}$ consists of all finite intersections of elements from $\mathcal{B}$, and $\mathcal{B}$ is a base of this topology (in the first sense).

As $\mathcal{B}$ is a collection of subsets of X , we can view it as a poset under inclusion, and thus a subcategory of $\text{open}(X)$.

1.4.1 Definition (B-Sheaves)

Let X be a topological space with a given base $\mathcal{B}$. Define a **$\mathcal{B}$ -presheaf** to be a functor $\mathcal{F}: \mathcal{B}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{Set}$. This presheaf is a **$\mathcal{B}$ -sheaf** if it satisfies the following two axioms:

- (1) the **identity axiom**: if $B = \bigcup_i B_i$ is a basic covering and $f, g \in \mathcal{F}(B)$ such that $f|_{B_i} = g|_{B_i}$ for all i , then $f = g$.
- (2) the **gluing axiom**: if $B = \bigcup_i B_i$ is a basic covering and $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(B_i)$ are given for all i such that $f_i|_{B_k} = f_j|_{B_k}$ for all $B_k \subseteq B_i \cap B_j$, then there is an $f \in \mathcal{F}(B)$ such that $f|_{B_i} = f_i$ for all i .

We can rewrite the following axioms categorically as follows. For $B = \bigcup_i B_i$, the following diagram must be an equalizer map

$$\mathcal{F}(B) \xrightarrow{\varphi} \prod_i \mathcal{F}(B_i) \xrightarrow{\alpha} \beta \prod_{i,j,k} \mathcal{F}(B_{i,j,k})$$

where $\{B_{i,j,k}\}_k$ ranges over all basic sets contained in $B_i \cap B_j$, and

$$\theta = (\text{res}_{B,B_i})_i, \quad \alpha = (\text{res}_{B_i,B_k} \circ \text{proj}_i)_{i,j,k}, \quad \beta = (\text{res}_{B_j,B_k} \circ \text{proj}_j)_{i,j,k}.$$

Thus we can define $\mathcal{B}$ -sheaves over any category $\mathcal{C}$ with enough limits.

1.4.2 Definition

Denote the category of $\mathcal{C}$ -valued $\mathcal{B}$ -presheaves by $\mathcal{C}_B^{\text{pre}}$, and the category of $\mathcal{C}$ -valued $\mathcal{B}$ -sheaves by $\mathcal{C}_B$.

1.4.3 Theorem

Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a base for a topology on X , and $\mathcal{F}$ a sheaf of sets on this base. Then there is a unique sheaf of sets $\mathcal{F}^{\text{ext}}$ on X extending $\mathcal{F}$.

This extends to an equivalence of categories $\text{ext}: \text{Set}_B \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Set}_X: \text{res}$, where $\text{res}: \text{Set}_X \rightarrow \text{Set}_B$ is the obvious restriction functor.

Proof

For a $\mathcal{B}$ -sheaf we can define stalks much the same way as for a usual sheaf. For $p \in X$ define

$$\mathcal{F}_p = \text{colim}_{p \in B \in \mathcal{B}} \mathcal{F}(B).$$

Then define for $U \subseteq X$,

$$\mathcal{F}^{\text{ext}}(U) = \left\{ (f_p \in \mathcal{F}_p)_{p \in U} \mid \begin{array}{l} \text{for all } p \in U \text{ there is a } B \in \mathcal{B} \text{ with } p \in B \subseteq U, s \in \mathcal{F}(B) \\ \text{such that } s_q = f_q \text{ for all } q \in B \end{array} \right\}.$$

There are obvious restriction maps and it is easy to see that this is a sheaf. Furthermore it is easy to see that $\mathcal{F}^{\text{ext}}(B)$ is the image of $\mathcal{F}(B)$ under $\iota_{\mathcal{F}}$ which is an injection as for usual sheaves. $\blacksquare$

1.4.4 Remark

Suppose we have an open cover $X = \bigcup_i U_i$ and for each i a sheaf of sets $\mathcal{F}_i$ on U_i . Furthermore suppose we have isomorphisms

$$\varphi_{ij}: \mathcal{F}_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{F}_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$$

such that φ_{ii} is the identity and

$$\varphi_{jk} \circ \varphi_{ij} = \varphi_{ik}$$

for all i, j, k on $U_i \cap U_j \cap U_k$.

There then exists a unique sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on X such that $\mathcal{F}|_{U_i}$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{F}_i$.

This is because we can define a base $\mathcal{B}$ consisting of those open subsets contained in some U_i , i.e. $\mathcal{B} = \bigcup_i \text{open}(U_i)$. Then there is a unique way to extend the $\mathcal{F}_i$ s to a $\mathcal{B}$ -sheaf. For $U \subseteq U_i$ we define $\mathcal{F}(U) = \mathcal{F}_i(U)$ (this is well-defined because if $U \subseteq U_i \cap U_j$ then $\mathcal{F}_i(U) \cong \mathcal{F}_j(U)$), and the restriction maps are given by the restriction maps of $\mathcal{F}_i$ and the φ_{ij} . That is, for $U \subseteq U_i$ and $V \subseteq U_j$ where $U \subseteq V$ we define $\text{res}: \mathcal{F}_j(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_i(U)$ by

$$\text{res} = \mathcal{F}_j(V) \xrightarrow{\text{res}_j} \mathcal{F}_j(U) \xrightarrow{\varphi_{ji}} \mathcal{F}_i(U).$$

The conditions on φ_{ij} ensure that this is a $\mathcal{B}$ -sheaf, and we can extend it to a sheaf on X via the above theorem.

1.5 Abelian categories of sheaves

Recall that for a sheaf of rings $\mathcal{O}_X$, an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -**module** is a sheaf of Abelian groups $\mathcal{F}$ such that each $\mathcal{F}(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -module in a compatible way (definition 1.1.11). A sheaf of Abelian groups is a $\mathbb{Z}$ -module, so $\mathcal{O}_X$ -

modules generalize the concept of sheaves of Abelian groups much like how modules generalize the concept of Abelian groups.

The goal of this section is to demonstrate that the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules (and in particular sheaves of Abelian groups) forms an Abelian category.

To do this we need to show that the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules has kernels and cokernels, and that monics are kernels and epics are cokernels. Firstly let us consider $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\text{pre}}$, the category of presheaf $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. The definition here is the same as definition 1.1.11 except we require only that $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf.

Now $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\text{pre}}$ is complete and cocomplete. If $\Phi: I \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\text{pre}}$ is a diagram, then there is an obvious forgetful functor $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\text{pre}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}_X^{\text{pre}}$. Composing this with Φ we can take the co/limit, and then there is an obvious $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module structure on the resulting object (this is the same situation as with $\mathbf{Mod}_R \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$).

Then sheafification lifts to $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\text{pre}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$. This is clear by considering $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ explicitly. Thus $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is a reflective subcategory of $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\text{pre}}$, and since the latter is co/complete so too is the former.

In particular the kernel of a $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ -morphism is the kernel of it viewed as a morphism in $\mathbf{Ab}_X^{\text{pre}}$, and its cokernel is the sheafification of this morphism.

Recall that the stalk of a morphism in $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is an $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ -module. Thus we view $\bullet_p$ as a functor

$$\bullet_p: \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X} \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}.$$

When $\mathcal{O}_X = \mathbb{Z}$ then $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is the same as $\mathbf{Ab}_X$, and $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is the same as $\mathbb{Z}$ so that $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}} \cong \mathbf{Ab}$. Thus all of the following results hold for sheaves of Abelian groups.

1.5.1 Lemma

Taking stalks preserves kernels and cokernels: for $p \in X$ and a morphism $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules,

$$(\ker \varphi)_p \cong \ker(\varphi_p), \quad (\text{coker } \varphi)_p \cong \text{coker}(\varphi_p).$$

Proof

This is clear for cokernels, as the stalk at p amounts to taking a certain colimit, and colimits (such as cokernels) commute with colimits.

For kernels we can show this directly. We view both $(\ker \varphi)_p$ and $\ker(\varphi_p)$ canonically as subobjects of $\mathcal{F}_p$, in which case it is clear that there is an equality. ■

1.5.2 Lemma

In $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$, a morphism $\varphi: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is monic iff its stalks are monic, epic iff its stalks are epic, and an isomorphism iff its stalks are isomorphisms.

Note:

It doesn't matter if we view φ_p as existing in $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}$ or $\mathbf{Set}$; a module morphism (in the ordinary sense) is a monomorphism/epimorphism/isomorphism iff it is injective/surjective/bijective.

Note that in lieu of this, a $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ -morphism with any of the above properties has those properties in $\mathbf{Ab}_X$ and $\mathbf{Set}_X$.

Proof

First we note that stalks determine a morphism: if $\varphi_p = \psi_p$ for all $p \in X$ then $\varphi = \psi$. This is because the forgetful functor $U: \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}_X$ is faithful, and commutes with taking stalks. So $U\varphi_p = U\psi_p$, which implies $U\varphi = U\psi$ by proposition 1.3.4, and thus $\varphi = \psi$.

Then the proofs of proposition 1.3.5 and proposition 1.3.10 are valid here. ■

This allows us to prove the desired result.

1.5.3 Theorem

$\text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is an Abelian category.

Proof

As already shown, $\text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is co/complete. Furthermore it is clearly a pre-additive category. We need only show that for a monic φ and an epic ψ ,

$$\varphi = \ker \text{coker } \varphi, \quad \psi = \text{coker } \ker \psi.$$

But this is true only if for all $p \in X$,

$$\varphi_p = \ker \text{coker } \varphi_p, \quad \psi_p = \text{coker } \ker \psi_p \quad (1)$$

(parentheses on the left-hand sides of the equations here are unnecessary, as per lemma 1.5.1). By lemma 1.5.2 φ_p, ψ_p are monic and epic respectively, so (1) holds as $\text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}$ is Abelian. ■

1.5.4 Lemma

Let φ be a $\text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ -morphism, then $\text{im } \varphi$ is the sheafification of the image presheaf of φ . In particular $(\text{im } \varphi)_p = \text{im}(\varphi_p)$.

Proof

We know that $\text{im}_{\text{pre}} \varphi = \ker_{\text{pre}} \text{coker}_{\text{pre}} \varphi$, while $\text{im } \varphi = \ker \text{coker } \varphi$. Since $\text{coker} = \text{coker}_{\text{pre}}^{\text{sh}}$ and $\ker = \ker_{\text{pre}}^{\text{sh}} = \ker_{\text{pre}} \text{ so}$

$$\text{im } \varphi = \ker_{\text{pre}}^{\text{sh}} \text{coker}_{\text{pre}}^{\text{sh}} \varphi = (\ker_{\text{pre}} \text{coker}_{\text{pre}} \varphi)^{\text{sh}} = (\text{im}_{\text{pre}} \varphi)^{\text{sh}}$$

as desired.

The second point follows from stalks commuting with kernels and cokernels. ■

1.5.5 Corollary

The following sequence of $\text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ -morphisms

$$\mathcal{F} \xrightarrow{\alpha} \mathcal{G} \xrightarrow{\beta} \mathcal{H}$$

is exact iff

$$\mathcal{F}_p \xrightarrow{\alpha_p} \mathcal{G}_p \xrightarrow{\beta_p} \mathcal{H}_p$$

is exact for all $p \in X$.

Proof

The former is exact iff $\text{im } \alpha = \ker \beta$ iff $(\text{im } \alpha)_p = (\ker \beta)_p$ for all $p \in X$, which happens iff $\text{im } \alpha_p = \ker \beta_p$,

i.e. if the latter sequence is exact. ■

An immediate consequence of this corollary is the following.

1.5.6 Corollary

Taking stalks is an exact functor $\bullet_p: \text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X} \rightarrow \text{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}$.